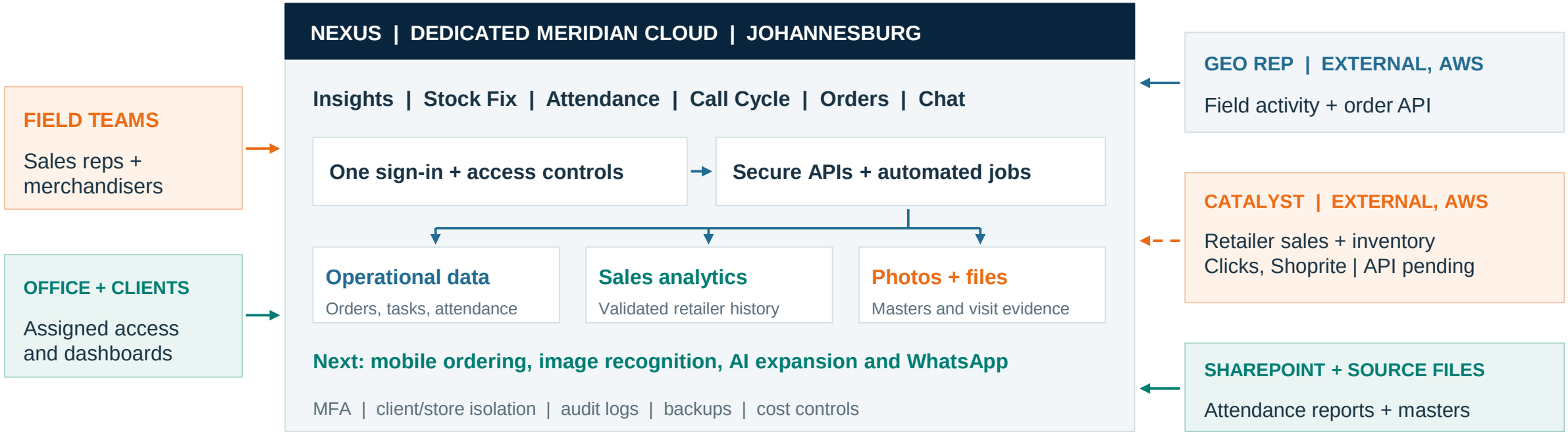
Keep Nexus in-house, with accountable support

Johannesburg hosting is the design basis. About 1,000 users: field teams first, with office and client dashboards.



Logical hosting model, not migration sign-off. Confirm the cloud platform and each resource location; dotted link = future API.

OWN THE BUSINESS PLATFORM

Meridian controls its code, data, access and roadmap; supplier exit stays possible.

DESIGN FOR THE STORE VISIT

Prioritise coverage, shelf availability, accepted orders and task completion.

BUY EXPERTISE SELECTIVELY

Keep useful Geo Rep and Catalyst services. Add specialist support without handover.

In-house control comes with operating obligations

The largest exposure is concentrated knowledge and support. Fund the controls before expanding business-critical use.

RISK / BUSINESS IMPACT	LEVEL*	REQUIRED CONTROL / ACCEPTANCE EVIDENCE	PROPOSED OWNER
Key-person dependency Absence delays fixes	H > M	Two-person deployment and restore cover; runbooks, code review and a support retainer.	Director + IT
Client / staff data exposure GPS, photos and reports	H > M	MFA, client/store isolation tests, scoped service access; device revocation and retention rules.	Information Officer + IT
Outage / failed cutover Visits and jobs disrupted	H > M	Staged releases, job alerts, versioned backups and restore drills; rehearse rollback and a regional-outage response.	Cloud lead + QA
Offline work / order loss Poor signal or lost device	H > M	Encrypted local queue; restart and sync tests; duplicate-safe orders with clear pending, accepted and rejected states.	Mobile lead + Field Ops
Supplier or data failure Wrong or stale actions	H > M	API contracts, retries and freshness alerts; reconcile retailer totals and store/product masters; retain export rights.	BI + API owner
AI misuse / cost growth Leakage, mistakes, overrun	H > M	Permission-scoped AI; approval before actions; quality tests, usage limits and per-user cost monitoring.	AI lead + Finance

*Qualitative judgement, not an audit: High before controls; Medium target only after evidence is accepted. Residual risk remains.

A Johannesburg account is a foundation, not a security or POPIA guarantee.

Meridian still owns access, devices, data governance and incident response; external processing and regional recovery need review.

Approve the capability, not an unconditional rebuild

Recommended: Meridian-led development plus contracted cloud/security support. Keep suppliers where they deliver proven value.

OPERATING OPTION	BENEFIT	DISADVANTAGE	ASSESSMENT
Meridian team only	Maximum delivery control	Recruitment + on-call burden	**Conditional**
Meridian + specialist support	Control with backup expertise	Internal team + support cost	**Preferred**
Geo Rep-led delivery	Potential delivery/support capacity	Contract, API and exit dependence	**Quote + proof**

COST: COMPARE THE FULL 36 MONTHS

Setup / migration + 36 x monthly operating cost

Include people, support, cloud, supplier/API fees, devices, AI, image recognition and WhatsApp usage.

R10,000/month difference = R360,000 over 3 years.

No verified quotes or workload estimate: savings are unproven. Track cost per active field user, accepted order and visit.

90-DAY ASSURANCE PLAN / PROPOSED

01	**Days 0-30**	Confirm platform, team cover and budget; prove access controls and backup recovery.
02	**Days 31-60**	Pilot field sync, supplier feeds and orders; reconcile data and test rollback.
03	**Days 61-90**	Expand after business acceptance; stage IR and WhatsApp behind separate gates.

APPROVE: Meridian-led Nexus, named backup and funded support. Retain suppliers until replacements pass.

Cost tools: Azure [6] Google Cloud [7]

Phases are a proposal, not a migration or feature-delivery promise